

Restricting Access in Moodle

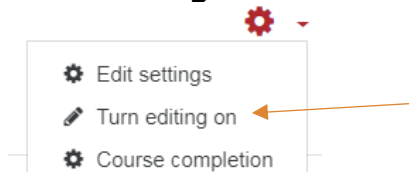
Access restrictions can be placed on resources and activities in Moodle. These restrictions include a date restriction or a grade restriction, for example, where students cannot access an activity or resource until they have met certain conditions. This can be useful for flow control of a course – for example, if you would like students to read a resource before doing a quiz, you can make sure that the quiz cannot be accessed until students have clicked on the resource. There are also interesting uses of access restrictions for gamification, with the idea that items are unlocked once a certain grade is achieved.

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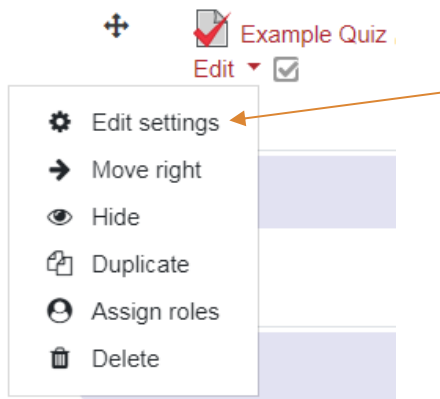
- [Create an access restriction](#)
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Create an access restriction

1. On your Moodle course main page, click the **Settings button** and then click **Turn editing on** from the dropdown menu.



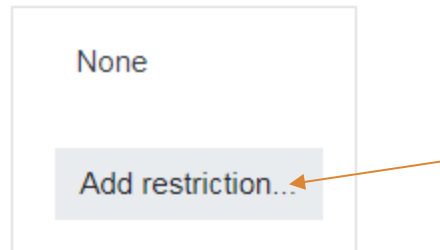
2. Locate the activity you'd like to place an access restriction on and click on the 'Edit' link beside the name. Click on **Edit settings**.



3. In the settings menu for the activity, locate the 'Restrict Access' section and click on the **Add restriction** button.

▼ Restrict access

Access restrictions



4. A list of restriction types is available:

Add restriction...

Activity completion	Require students to complete (or not complete) another activity.
Date	Prevent access until (or from) a specified date and time.
Grade	Require students to achieve a specified grade.
Group	Allow only students who belong to a specified group, or all groups.
User profile	Control access based on fields within the student's profile.
Restriction set	Add a set of nested restrictions to apply complex logic.

Cancel

Activity completion: unlock this activity/resource once a student has completed the activity completion requirements as set in a specific activity (needs activity completion turned on in the course).

Date: prevents access to an activity/resource until a certain time. Can also be used to hide an activity after a certain date.

NOTE: be extra careful with setting an access restriction date on activities that you can already set due dates for (eg. quizzes and assignments). **This access restriction can override dates you have already set in the settings for that activity.** You do not need to add a date restriction on activities that already have due dates in their settings.

Grade: prevents access to an activity/resource until a student has achieved a specified grade in a prior activity. This grade could be a minimum or maximum grade achievement.

Group: restrict access to an activity/resource to a certain group (groups has to have been previously set up prior to using this setting).

User profile: restrict access to an activity/resource based on contents of a user's profile (eg. email address or last name).

Restriction set: add nested restrictions where students will need to complete several tasks or meet more than one set of criteria to unlock an activity/resource.

- Once you've determined what kind of restriction set you'd like to create, there are a few dropdown menus that will help refine it.

Activity Completion:

The screenshot shows the 'Activity Completion' configuration interface. It includes a 'Student' dropdown set to 'must', a 'match the following' label, and a nested 'Activity completion' box. Inside this box, there is a dropdown for 'Example Assignment' and a 'must be complete with' dropdown. An 'Add restriction...' button is at the bottom left. Three callout boxes with arrows provide guidance: one points to the 'must' dropdown with the text 'Student **MUST** or **MUST NOT** achieve the activity completion.', another points to the 'must be complete with' dropdown with the text 'Activity completion condition.', and a third points to the 'Example Assignment' dropdown with the text 'Activity that this restriction is dependent on.' An orange 'Please set' label is also visible near the 'must be complete with' dropdown.

Date:

Student **must** match the following

Date **from** 10 January 2019 00 : 00

Add restriction...

Student **MUST** or **MUST NOT** access before/from a specific date.

Activity or resource available TO or FROM a specified date.

Grade:

Student **must** match the following

Grade Example Assignment

☒ must be ≥ 80 %

☐ must be < %

Add restriction...

Student **MUST** or **MUST NOT** achieve a specific grade set below.

Set the activity and the grade(s) that must be achieved on that activity. Note that there are two fields – one for grades equal to or above a grade, and a field for grades below a certain amount.

Group:

The screenshot shows the 'Group' restriction configuration. It includes a 'Student' dropdown set to 'must', a 'match the following' label, and a 'Group' dropdown set to 'Example Group'. An 'Add restriction...' button is at the bottom. Two orange arrows point from text boxes to the 'must' and 'Example Group' dropdowns.

Student **must** match the following

Group **Example Group**

Add restriction...

Student **MUST** or **MUST NOT** be a part of the specified group.

Specify the group affected by this access restriction.

User profile:

The screenshot shows the 'User profile' restriction configuration. It includes a 'Student' dropdown set to 'must', a 'match' label, and an 'all' dropdown. Below are two profile field restrictions: 'Surname' is equal to 'Mattila' and 'First name' is equal to 'Melanie'. An 'Add restriction...' button is at the bottom. Two orange arrows point from text boxes to the 'must' dropdown and the 'Surname' field.

Student **must** match all of the following

User profile field **Surname** is equal to **Mattila**

and

User profile field **First name** is equal to **Melanie**

Add restriction...

Student **MUST** or **MUST NOT** have elements in their profile that match the following.

There are several profile elements you can choose from. If you choose to restrict to a particular student, choose the 'email' option, ID number, or add a second restriction so that this restriction includes their first name and surname.

Restriction set:

The screenshot shows the Moodle Access Restrictions interface. At the top, there are dropdowns for 'Student', 'must', 'match', 'all', and 'of the following'. An orange arrow points from a text box to the 'all' dropdown. Below this, there is a section for 'Student' with 'must' and 'match' dropdowns, and 'any' and 'of the following' dropdowns. An orange arrow points from a text box to the 'any' dropdown. Below this, there is a section for 'Grade' with a 'Course total' dropdown. There are two checkboxes: 'must be ≥ 80%' (checked) and 'must be < %'. An orange arrow points from a text box to the 'Add restriction...' button. Below this, there is a section for 'Group' with an 'Example Group' dropdown. An orange arrow points from a text box to the 'Add restriction...' button. Below this, there is a section for 'Activity completion' with an 'Example Assignment' dropdown and a 'must be marked compl' dropdown. An orange arrow points from a text box to the 'Add restriction...' button.

Specify whether a student has to achieve ALL of the requirements listed, or ANY of them.

Add another restriction to this restriction set.

Determine whether you would like the Activity Restriction is visible to all students

Determine whether or not you'd like your restricted activity/resource to be visible or not. You can make the restricted activity look like this, so that the student has an idea that they need to meet the criteria to view the activity/resource:



Example Quiz

Restricted Not available unless: You get an appropriate score in **Example Assignment**

OR, you can hide the activity/resource completely if you do not want students to see it at all if they don't have access to it. To do that, locate the 'eyeball' icon on the access restriction you set:

- 👁 If left unclicked (open), students **will see** the activity and the requirements needed to open, but **won't be able to open it** until they have met the requirements.
- 👁 If clicked (closed), students **will not see** the activity and the requirements needed to open until they have met the requirements.

For more information contact Moodle Help at moodle@norquest.ca.

